



What's wrong with Windows 8?

...and what we want from Windows 9

editor@thinkdigit.com

While a lot of people rushed to avail of the cheap upgrade to Windows 8, some of us who were pretty content with Windows 7 (and also believing that every alternate Windows is a flop), decide to wait it out. Money saved, is all we will say. See, the problem is, we're using desktops or laptops (PCs basically) and Microsoft has, in our humble opinion, decided to dump all of us PC users into the nearest sewer.

It's like this: we PC users, we're part of a subset of people who Microsoft takes for granted. They hold a monopoly over the PC market, so where will we go? We'll bitch and moan, cry foul, spew venom at Microsoft, but in the end, we will buy (or pirate) their OSes anyway, because we're too lazy to learn Linux, and not stupid or rich enough to buy all new hardware in the form of a Mac.

In the end, we will upgrade to Windows 8 by default when we buy a new laptop, or to Windows 9 by choice, when the alternate OS jinx takes a breather. We really have no option, and no matter how free you think your choices are, we content creators are really stuck with what Microsoft decides is best for us!

Top 3 ways Windows 8 fails

So let's list out the top ways in which Windows 8 fails on the PC.

1. Intuition

When Windows 95 was launched to the tune of Start me up by the rolling stones, because of the Start button and menu, it was brilliant. Eighteen years later, PC users still want a place to start using a computer from. Vista did away with the word "Start" but still kept the button, as did Windows 7. With Windows 8, you get the word "Start" coming back, but it's just text; a label for an intro screen that has some "Live tiles" and that's about it. For the first time ever, in the Windows environment, PC users were left scratching their heads as to how they could, say, launch Photoshop. That's just dumb.

That's not all. For years on Windows / Mac and Linux, buttons are designed to look like buttons. There's a drop shadow, or a bevelled look, something. Windows 8 has plain text. You can't tell what's meant to be clicked, and what's not.

What we want: We're hoping that Windows 9 will bring back the intuition, instead of just expecting people to get used to Windows 8's warped UI. Stop trying to be two things at once, and choose one or the other. We're also hoping Windows 9 will label buttons better.

2. Mix and match - two OSes in one?

When you look at Apple, and what they achieved with iOS. You know it's because they threw away the Mac OSX interface, and said, "No! Different device, different OS." Microsoft, some believe, is trying to please everyone by mixing and matching the touch and mouse interfaces for mobile / tablet users and us poor PC chaps, and failing miserably at doing both.

We believe that Microsoft knows damn well what it's doing. Some figures suggest that there will be 2 billion PCs in use by 2014. PCs, unlike smartphones and tablets, have a longer life, and thus although the sales figures for PCs worldwide may seem to be falling, laptops and desktops aren't going anywhere just yet. We're still going to use them, and with Microsoft's monopoly, most of us are going to use some flavour of Windows for the next 5 years at the minimum.

What would you do if you owned a company that reached 2 billion (at least) people via your software on one platform, and were trying to convert them to your software on another platform? Exactly what Windows 8 did. Even if you have a PC without a touch interface, Microsoft is getting you used to the UI of their touch devices - forcefully. You can't buy a new laptop / ultrabook without Windows 8 these days, and that means you're already getting used to their Metro UI.